

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: 1. Aptitude, attitude and value: the three-object taxonomy

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1. Aptitude, attitude and value: the three-object taxonomy

[1] Aptitude is capacity to perform a task or role competently.

|
v

[2] Attitude is an evaluative stance toward a specific object.

|
v

[3] Value is a general cross-situational standard of worth.

|
v

[4] Aptitude is trainable through deliberate practice and mentoring.

|
v

[5] Attitude can change with experience; values are more enduring.

|
v

[6] Recruitment tests primarily measure aptitude and intelligence.

|
v

[7] Probation and appraisal assess dedication and initiative.

|
v

[8] Confusing the three weakens assessment design and answers.

|
v

VERDICT -> Classify the object of assessment precisely before applying it to a civil-service case.

ANSWER USE -> Open foundational-values answers by distinguishing what is being assessed.

MUST REMEMBER: Aptitude is learnable capacity for role performance; integrity aligns justified values, words and action, impartiality avoids irrelevant preference, non-partisanship avoids party allegiance, objectivity uses relevant evidence, and empathy differs from compassion's motivation to help.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: 2. Integrity under discretion: the hardest test

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2. Integrity under discretion: the hardest test

[1] Integrity means consistency of values across situations.

|
v

[2] The Nolan Committee treats integrity and honesty as separate principles.

|
v

[3] Integrity is costless to display when observed.

|
v

[4] It is genuinely tested when discretion, secrecy and gain converge.

|
v

[5] The state cannot legislate integrity directly.

|
v

[6] It legislates proxies: asset declarations and conflict disclosures.

|
v

[7] Random inspections and cooling-off periods add observable checks.

|
v

[8] Integrity proxies monitor behaviour but cannot guarantee character.

|
v

VERDICT -> Integrity is the precondition for every other foundational value to be trustworthy.

ANSWER USE -> Use the discretion-secrecy-gain test to show how integrity is operationally assessed.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: 3. Impartiality is not identical treatment

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3. Impartiality is not identical treatment

[1] Impartiality requires decisions on merit without personal bias.

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v

[2] It does not require identical treatment regardless of need.

|
v

[3] Needs-based support for weaker sections can be impartial.

|
v

[4] The criterion is whether differentiation is transparent and rule-based.

|
v

[5] A published fee waiver for BPL applicants is impartial.

|
v

[6] An informal favour for a relative is nepotism under any label.

|
v

[7] The safeguard is transparent eligibility, not removal of discretion.

|
v

[8] Affirmative facilitation strengthens equality of access.

|
v

VERDICT -> Test the criteria, not the outcome, to distinguish impartiality from favouritism.

ANSWER USE -> Apply to welfare-scheme, reservation, or targeted-delivery answers.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: 4. Non-partisanship and the transfer industry

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4. Non-partisanship and the transfer industry

[1] Non-partisanship requires party-neutral official conduct.

|
v

[2] Personal political views are permitted; official action is not.

|
v

[3] The ARC documents transfer as the politicians' control weapon.

|
v

[4] Robert Wade's AP study shows transfer as a lever for extraction.

|
v

[5] Without tenure protection, non-partisanship is structurally fragile.

|
v

[6] The Fifth Pay Commission recommended three-to-five-year tenure.

|
v

[7] Civil Services Board insulates transfers from political discretion.

|
v

[8] Training plus tenure protection produces durable non-partisanship.

|
v

VERDICT -> Non-partisanship is an institutional-design achievement, not just a personal virtue.

ANSWER USE -> Ground non-partisanship answers in structural analysis rather than exhortation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: 5. Empathy, sympathy and compassion: an ascending ladder

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5. Empathy, sympathy and compassion: an ascending ladder

[1] Sympathy feels for someone from outside with an implicit hierarchy.

|
v

[2] Empathy grasps another's situation from their frame of reference.

|
v

[3] Compassion adds a motivated commitment to relieve suffering.

|
v

[4] Only compassion necessarily issues in action or service design.

|
v

[5] A social media statement of sorrow is sympathy, not compassion.

|
v

[6] Listening to displaced families and adjusting relief is empathy.

|
v

[7] Redesigning pension verification for disabled applicants is compassion.

|
v

[8] GS-IV answers must translate feeling into a process change.

|
v

VERDICT -> Compassion earns marks only when it changes a defensible administrative process.

ANSWER USE -> Use the ladder to escalate from sentiment to service-design in any answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: 6. Enabler versus regulator: calibration spectrum

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6. Enabler versus regulator: calibration spectrum

[1] Facilitation removes barriers and proactively connects citizens to services.

|
v

[2] Regulation protects safety, equity and public interest.

|
v

[3] Single-window clearance consolidates multiple approvals for low-risk cases.

|
v

[4] Post-facto risk-based inspection replaces universal ex-ante gatekeeping.

|
v

[5] Deemed approval shifts incentive from delay to timely review.

|
v

[6] Pure facilitation without backstops risks regulatory capture.

|
v

[7] Excessive regulation without enabling stifles legitimate development.

|
v

[8] Calibration requires reliable risk-classification systems.

|
v

VERDICT -> The civil servant should sequence facilitation and regulation, not choose one exclusively.

ANSWER USE -> Use to build the calibrated-role paragraph in any enabler-regulator question.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: 7. Mission Karmayogi: values as trainable competencies

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7. Mission Karmayogi: values as trainable competencies

[1] NPCSCB approved by Cabinet on 2 September 2020.

|
v

[2] FRAC maps functional and behavioural competencies to roles.

|
v

[3] iGOT-Karmayogi delivers learning in 23 languages.

|
v

[4] KCM aligns roles with competencies and supports accountability and role-fit (CBC).

|
v

[5] AI Sarthi and AI Tutor showcased at IndiaAI Impact Summit (16-20 Feb 2026) for role-based personalised learning (CBC).

|
v

[6] Training reach does not prove ethical internalisation.

|
v

[7] Do not claim a general APAR linkage without a service-specific DoPT order.

|
v

[8] Values training needs supplementation by citizen feedback and field observation.

|
v

VERDICT -> Mission Karmayogi institutionalises values education; it cannot certify ethical conduct.

ANSWER USE -> Cite as the institutional bridge between values and role-based capacity.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: 8. Compassion versus favouritism: the boundary

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8. Compassion versus favouritism: the boundary

[1] Compassionate facilitation uses transparent published criteria.

|
v

[2] Favouritism uses informal selection without published justification.

|
v

[3] Both may look identical in form: expedited service for one person.

|
v

[4] The distinguishing test is whether criteria are rule-based and auditable.

|
v

[5] Written reasons for each discretionary decision create an audit trail.

|
v

[6] Periodic review of waiver and expedited-service patterns detects drift.

|
v

[7] Affirmative needs-based support passes the test; selective favour fails it.

|
v

[8] The safeguard is transparency, not the removal of all discretion.

|
v

VERDICT -> Compassion and impartiality coexist when discretion operates within published rules.

ANSWER USE -> Use to resolve the compassion-favouritism tension in welfare-delivery answers.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: 9. Tolerance and constitutional morality

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9. Tolerance and constitutional morality

[1] Tolerance means respect for diversity of belief, culture and viewpoint.

|
v

[2] It goes beyond passive non-interference to positive facilitation.

|
v

[3] Article 51A(e) anchors tolerance in a fundamental duty of secular conduct.

|
v

[4] Constitutional morality requires fidelity to constitutional values.

|
v

[5] Equal police protection for minority processions demonstrates tolerance.

|
v

[6] Ignoring a minority community is not tolerance but neglect.

|
v

[7] Tolerance does not require approval; it requires equal respect and access.

|
v

[8] Constitutional morality disciplines personal prejudice with public duty.

|
v

VERDICT -> Tolerance becomes a foundational administrative value through constitutional morality.

ANSWER USE -> Use to anchor diversity and secularism answers in specific constitutional provisions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: 10. Nolan seven versus GS-IV syllabus list

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10. Nolan seven versus GS-IV syllabus list

[1] Nolan lists selflessness, integrity, objectivity as shared with GS-IV.

|
v

[2] Nolan adds accountability, openness, honesty and leadership.

|
v

[3] GS-IV adds empathy, tolerance and compassion toward weaker sections.

|
v

[4] Non-partisanship appears in GS-IV but not explicitly in Nolan.

|
v

[5] Dedication to public service overlaps with Nolan's selflessness.

|
v

[6] The two lists are complementary, not identical.

|
v

[7] Equating them without qualification is a common exam trap.

|
v

[8] Indian civil-service ethics must address both frameworks.

|
v

VERDICT -> Know both lists and where they diverge to avoid a false equivalence trap.

ANSWER USE -> Use the overlap and gaps to answer any Nolan or foundational-values comparison.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Tolerance is principled forbearance, not approval of injustice; dedication is sustained public commitment, not obedience to an unlawful superior; political neutrality does not mean value-neutrality toward constitutional rights.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: 11. Values under pressure: an integration map

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11. Values under pressure: an integration map

[1] Discretion creates the space in which integrity is tested.

|
v

[2] Political transition tests non-partisanship most sharply.

|
v

[3] Election duty tests impartiality under direct political pressure.

|
v

[4] Welfare delivery tests compassion alongside impartial rule-application.

|
v

[5] Gender-specific challenges test impartiality reflexively.

|
v

[6] Service-delivery redesign tests compassion as operational output.

|
v

[7] Enabler-regulator framing tests dedication and objectivity together.

|
v

[8] Each value interacts with others under realistic administrative stress.

|
v

VERDICT -> Foundational values are tested in combination, not in isolation.

ANSWER USE -> Use to show multi-value interaction in any pressure-scenario question.

EVIDENCE / AUTHORITY / APPLICATION LIMIT: Civil-service values must be operationalised through recorded reasons, recusal, consultation, accessibility, competence, review and corrective action; Mission Karmayogi is a capacity framework, not evidence that every official possesses these values.

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12. PYQ and answer synthesis

- [1] 2025 Q5(b) tested enabler-facilitator with specific measures.
|
v
- [2] 2025 Q4(a) tested objectivity and critical thinking in welfare schemes.
|
v
- [3] 2025 Q5(a) tested devotion to duty and personal fulfilment.
|
v
- [4] 2024 Q6(a) tested gender-specific challenges and probity.
|
v
- [5] 2018-2021 tested Nolan principles, Buffett, and non-partisanship.
|
v
- [6] Name the value precisely rather than listing adjectives.
|
v
- [7] Show the institutional mechanism that operationalises the value.
|
v
- [8] Close with a qualified verdict acknowledging a real limitation.
|
v

VERDICT -> The highest-scoring answer moves from value to pressure to mechanism to example to limit.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the revision checklist before any foundational-values PYQ attempt.